THOMAS KEVERS

Technical Product & Delivery Leader | Web3, Digital Assets & Telecoms | AI-Enabled Delivery

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PROFILE

Technical Product & Delivery Leader taking complex products from zero to scale across Europe, Asia and Africa. Web3: Layer-1 (Cardano, Mina) and Layer-2 (Zeko Labs) blockchains, blockchain staking infrastructure (P2P.org), bridges, DEXs, smart contracts and blockchain digital identity (SDKs, node software). Telecoms: Telecom & Media practice at Altran (now Capgemini) and $100M+ Vodafone-branded device portfolios (smartphones, tablets, GPON fixed devices, IoT) at Vodafone Group. Builds and runs the organisation around delivery: 40+ person tribes, company-wide KPIs and Objectives and Key Results (OKR), executive and board governance, with strong ties to Finance and developer ecosystems. Certified AI Manager (KI-Manager), embedding AI into delivery and knowledge management.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

Product & Delivery

- Delivered one of the world's first blockchain identity deployments on Cardano, for the Ethiopian Ministry of Education.
- Took Zeko (ZK Layer-2) from testnet to Mainnet in 14 months, growing transactions and wallets by 2,000%.
- Delivered zkApp smart contracts on Mina Mainnet, enabling decentralised application building.
- Owned $100M+ Vodafone-branded device portfolios in up to 20 countries, launching the Facebook phone, the Vodafone 150 (the world's most affordable phone), the first Vodafone-branded Wi-Fi 6 router and the first B2C IoT proposition.

Organisation, Governance & Finance

- Built one of IOG's highest-retention tribes (40+ people) and grew its ecosystem to 1,000+ developers and $3M funding.
- Set up company-wide governance at Mina Foundation (OKR, ExCo, board), improving accountability and predictability.
- Raised company-wide OKR achievement from 50% to 65% at P2P.org.
- Cut infrastructure costs by $500K a year and Delegation Program delinquency to 0%, saving 1M MINA a year.

AI-Enabled Delivery

- Recovered approximately 15% of engineering velocity at Zeko Labs with a NotebookLM self-service knowledge base.
- Deployed AI-driven automation on Claude Enterprise, turning calls and Slack threads into prioritised Linear backlog items.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

COO / Head of Product & Delivery - Zeko Labs | *04/2025 - Present*

Layer-2 zkRollup on Mina Protocol - ZK privacy, DeFi, on-chain asset custody and bridging

- Led a 10-person cross-functional team (protocol, full-stack, DevOps, smart contracts, marketing) on a $1M budget through testnet, incentivised testnet and public Mainnet launch (06/2026).
- Ran the two-month Zeko Boom incentivised testnet and delivered the Zeko Bridge and Lumina DEX, the first bridge and first DEX in the Mina ecosystem.
- Secured three Mainnet application launches through a developer pipeline tracking key builders to deployment.
- Designed the operating model: org structure, execution cadence, product rituals and decision-making.
- Rolled out Claude Enterprise and NotebookLM as the team's AI stack for delivery automation and knowledge management.

Advisor - Programmes & Operational Excellence (fractional) - P2P.org | *07/2025 - 12/2025*

Non-custodial staking and digital-asset infrastructure for wallets, exchanges and institutional custodians

- Ran the company-wide KPI and OKR process across the organisation.
- Advised on delivery for staking infrastructure serving institutional custodians, exchanges and wallets in regulated markets.

VP of Programs & Operations - Mina Foundation | *11/2022 - 06/2025 (garden leave from 04/2025)*

Layer-1 blockchain - ZK-SNARKs

- Led an 18-month, $10M programme across Mina Foundation and o1Labs delivering zkApp smart contracts on Mainnet (live 4 June 2024), in four streams: ecosystem testing, security, a two-month incentivised testnet with all node operators, and the Mainnet upgrade.
- Ran security end-to-end, from auditor bench and light RFPs to contract negotiation, audit reports and bug-fix timelines; a bug bounty vendor switch increased vulnerability submissions by 600%.
- Set up company-wide governance reporting to the CEO: OKR framework, executive reporting, weekly senior meetings, Executive Committee (ExCo) and board preparation.
- Renegotiated infrastructure agreements and rebuilt the Delegation Program.
- Managed custody partnerships: point of contact for Finoa, integration lead for Taurus.

Head of Delivery, Atala PRISM - IOG (Cardano) | *07/2021 - 11/2022*

Blockchain infrastructure company behind Cardano - Atala PRISM digital identity

- Built and led a 40+ person engineering, product and delivery tribe, partnering with Talent Acquisition on hiring and HR on retention.
- Delivered the Atala PRISM identity platform for the Ethiopian Ministry of Education, serving millions of students.
- Owned a $7M annual budget, partnering with Finance on financial planning, accounts receivable and accounts payable.

Vodafone Group Product & Services | *11/2007 - 06/2021*

One of the world's largest telecoms companies - 300M+ customers globally

Senior Global Product & Programme Manager, Fixed Devices | 03/2017 - 06/2021

- Owned a $100M+ fixed-devices portfolio in 10 European markets, including GPON across the Vodafone footprint.
- Launched the first Vodafone-branded Wi-Fi 6 router in Spain and Portugal: around 20% lower device price, better quality.
- Led end-to-end New Product Introduction (NPI): RFP/RFQ, vendor selection, regulatory approval and launch, across vendors, local markets and procurement.

Senior Global Product Manager, Convergence & IoT | 11/2014 - 03/2017

- Launched Vodafone's first consumer (B2C) IoT offer with Samsung, owning roadmap, proposition, vendor selection and launch across European markets.

Senior Global Product Manager, Mobile Devices & Tablets | 11/2007 - 11/2014

- Owned $100M+ annual sales of Vodafone-branded smartphones and tablets across 20 countries; grew tablets 200% YoY (150K units, under 2% returns).
- Launched Vodafone's first sub-€100 smartphone with LTE, NFC and mobile payments.
- High-potential secondment to Vodafone Hong Kong as Global Programme Manager (11/2009 - 11/2011): launched the Vodafone Facebook phone and the Vodafone 150 and 250, marketed as the world's most affordable phones; 2M+ units across 15 countries, including India and South Africa.

Lead Consultant, Telecom & Media - Altran Group | *09/2002 - 10/2007*

- Delivered network rollout at KPN Orange Belgium (coverage 55% to 90% in 12 months), cut testing time by 40% at Telefonica/O2 UK and improved PMO at Symbian.

EDUCATION

- Master in Industrial Management - KU Leuven (Katholieke Universiteit Leuven)
- Master in Engineering (Electronics & Communications) - Université catholique de Louvain (UCLouvain)

CERTIFICATIONS

- AI: Certified AI Manager (KI-Manager, STARTPLATZ AI Hub) | Google AI Essentials | Google AI Professional
- Blockchain: IBM Blockchain Essentials | Bitcoin & Cryptocurrencies (Princeton University)
- Delivery: PRINCE2 Practitioner | MSP | ITIL v3 | Kanban Professional